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United States Patent	12414738
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
Inventor(s)	Lazou; Panayiotis et al.

Insole layer for monitoring human lower limb and foot performance

Abstract

An insole layer includes a top cover layer, a bottom cover layer, and a flexible printed circuit board disposed between the top cover layer and the bottom cover layer. The flexible printed circuit board includes a motion-tracking device, a processor, and a power supply. The motion-tracking device includes a plurality of sensors, wherein each sensor is configured to detect motion of one of a plurality of sensing areas disposed adjacent to a lower surface of the flexible printed circuit board. The processor is configured to receive motion data generated by the motion-tracking device. The power supply device is coupled to the motion-tracking device and the processor.

Inventors: Lazou; Panayiotis (Limassol, CY), Gray; Andrew (Lilli Pilli, AU), Lauri; Kaspar (Harjumaa, EE), Koplimets; Erki (Harjumaa, EE), Tozen; Kristjan (Tallinn, EE), Lumiste; Henri (Harjumaa, EE)

Applicant: SportScientia Pte. Ltd. (Singapore, SG)

Family ID: 1000008820930

Assignee: SPORTSCIENTIA PTE. LTD. (Singapore, SG)

Appl. No.: 17/485207

Filed: September 24, 2021

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20220087364 A1	Mar. 24, 2022

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63082754 20200924

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **A61B5/00** (20060101); **A43B3/34** (20220101); **A43B13/22** (20060101); **A43B17/14** (20060101); **A61B5/103** (20060101); **A61B5/11** (20060101); **G01P13/00** (20060101); **G06N20/00** (20190101); **H02J7/00** (20060101); **H05K1/03** (20060101); **H05K1/18** (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **A61B5/6807** (20130101); **A43B3/34** (20220101); **A43B13/22** (20130101); **A43B17/14** (20130101); **A61B5/1038** (20130101); **A61B5/1107** (20130101); **A61B5/112** (20130101); **A61B5/486** (20130101); **A61B5/7203** (20130101); **A61B5/725** (20130101); **A61B5/7267** (20130101); **G01P13/00** (20130101); **G06N20/00** (20190101); **H02J7/0042** (20130101); **H05K1/0366** (20130101); **H05K1/182** (20130101); **H05K1/189** (20130101); **H05K2201/09036** (20130101); **H05K2201/10037** (20130101); **H05K2201/10098** (20130101); **H05K2201/10151** (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

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Primary Examiner: Tu; Aurelie H

Attorney, Agent or Firm: NIXON PEABODY LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of, and priority to, U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/082,754 filed on Sep. 24, 2020, which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention relates generally to monitoring human health metrics, and more specifically, to an insole layer for monitoring human lower limb and foot performance using sensors in the insole layer.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Sports injuries are commonly caused by poor training methods, structural abnormalities, weakness in muscles, tendons, ligaments, and unsafe training environments. It is imperative to receive continuous assessments of athletes during training and open play during a match such that any assumptions related to performance and injury be validated. As an example, 'athlete load' and other markers related to intensity of movements often rely on acceleration characteristics of the upper portion of the back as measured by a Global Positioning System (GPS) device. This assumes that intensity of movements are solely a function of acceleration characteristics as a substitute for the ground reaction forces, and therefore, provides a wholesome understanding of vulnerability to any specific injury. However, GPS devices have limited ability to reveal how much load is experienced in any specific anatomical structure from foot to neck, and should only be one consideration when assessing 'athlete load', performance, and risk of injury.

(3) While evidence-based research in sports medicine has become an important component of minimizing injury risk and providing rehabilitative care after injury, there remains an ongoing need to develop systems and methods that monitor and record high-quality evidential data in order to make the prevention and treatment of injuries more impactful. In particular, systems and methods that monitor and record data not only in controlled environments of the clinic, but also during training and open play would help provide a continuous stream of real-time and environmental data that can address any gap in understanding the dynamics of performance before, during, after, and even in absence of injury. Such data would help determine external parameters of performance and internal parameters of how the body is responding to the demands of training and open play. While the external parameters are the face-value markers that can be used as performance snapshots relating to overall intensity and tactical play, the internal parameters provide information about risk of injury and thus may provide a basis of specific conditioning and rehabilitation after a training or

playing session.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(4) The term embodiment and like terms, e.g., implementation, configuration, aspect, example, and option, are intended to refer broadly to all of the subject matter of this disclosure and the claims below. Statements containing these terms should be understood not to limit the subject matter described herein or to limit the meaning or scope of the claims below. Embodiments of the present disclosure covered herein are defined by the claims below, not this summary. This summary is a high-level overview of various aspects of the disclosure and introduces some of the concepts that are further described in the Detailed Description section below. This summary is not intended to identify key or essential features of the claimed subject matter. This summary is also not intended to be used in isolation to determine the scope of the claimed subject matter. The subject matter should be understood by reference to appropriate portions of the entire specification of this disclosure, any or all drawings, and each claim.

(5) According to certain aspects of the present disclosure, an insole layer includes a top cover layer, a bottom cover layer, and a flexible printed circuit board disposed between the top cover layer and the bottom cover layer. The flexible printed circuit board includes a motion-tracking device, a processor, and a power supply. The motion-tracking device includes a plurality of sensors, wherein each sensor is configured to detect motion of one of a plurality of sensing areas disposed adjacent to a lower surface of the flexible printed circuit board. The processor is configured to receive motion data generated by the motion-tracking device. The power supply device is coupled to the motion-tracking device and the processor.

(6) The above summary is not intended to represent each embodiment or every aspect of the present disclosure. Rather, the foregoing summary merely provides an example of some of the novel aspects and features set forth herein. The above features and advantages, and other features and advantages of the present disclosure, will be readily apparent from the following detailed description of representative embodiments and modes for carrying out the present invention, when taken in connection with the accompanying drawings and the appended claims. Additional aspects of the disclosure will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art in view of the detailed description of various embodiments, which is made with reference to the drawings, a brief description of which is provided below.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The disclosure, and its advantages and drawings, will be better understood from the following description of representative embodiments together with reference to the accompanying drawings. These drawings depict only representative embodiments, and are therefore not to be considered as limitations on the scope of the various embodiments or claims.

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic representation of a motion analytics system having a sock with an insole layer for capturing motion data of a user, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2A is a perspective view showing a first embodiment of a sock with an insole layer for capturing motion data of a user, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 2B is a perspective view showing a second embodiment of a sock with an insole layer and an electronic pad for capturing motion data of a user, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 3 is a front view showing the electronic pad of FIG. 2B on a sock for capturing motion data of a user, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 4A is a perspective view of an insole layer for capturing motion data of a user, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

- (7) FIG. 4B is a top view of the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 4C is a side view of the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (9) FIG. 4D a bottom view of the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 5 is an exploded bottom perspective view of the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (11) FIG. 6A is a bottom perspective view of a flexible printed circuit board disposed within the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (12) FIG. 6B is a top perspective view of the flexible printed circuit board of FIG. 6A disposed within the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 6C is a bottom view of the flexible printed circuit board of FIG. 6A disposed within the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 6D is a side view of the flexible printed circuit board of FIG. 6A disposed within the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (15) FIG. 7A is a bottom perspective view showing a front sensor module of the flexible printed circuit board of FIG. 6A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (16) FIG. 7B is a bottom perspective view showing a rear sensor module of the flexible printed circuit board of FIG. 6A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (17) FIG. 8 is perspective view of a waterproof membrane for covering ventilation openings in the front sensor module of FIG. 7A and the rear sensor module of FIG. 7B, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (18) FIG. 9A is a top perspective view showing an attachment bracket of a charging socket of the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (19) FIG. 9B is a bottom perspective view showing the attachment bracket of FIG. 9A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (20) FIG. 10A is a bottom perspective view showing an upper frame of a central enclosure for housing electronics embedded in the flexible printed circuit board, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (21) FIG. 10B is a top perspective view showing the upper frame of FIG. 10A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (22) FIG. 10C is a bottom perspective view showing a lower frame of a central enclosure for housing electronics embedded in the flexible printed circuit board, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (23) FIG. 10D is a top perspective view showing the lower frame of FIG. 10C, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (24) FIG. 11A is a block diagram showing a wireless radio frequency (RF) charging system of the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (25) FIG. 11B is a bottom perspective view showing the flexible printed circuit board of FIG. 6A having electronics associated with the wireless RF charging system of FIG. 11A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (26) FIG. 12A is a block diagram showing a direct current (DC) charging system of the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (27) FIG. 12B is a top perspective view showing a DC charging apparatus including a DC charging station for charging the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (28) FIG. 12C is a top perspective view of the DC charging station of FIG. 12B, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.
- (29) FIG. 12D is a top perspective exploded view showing the DC charging apparatus of FIG. 12B,

according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(30) FIG. 12E is a perspective view showing a charging cable of the DC charging apparatus of FIG. 12B, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(31) FIG. 13 is a schematic representation of charging the insole layer of FIG. 4A on a stationary rack module, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(32) FIG. 14 is a schematic representation of charging the insole layer of FIG. 4A on a portable sleeve module, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(33) FIG. 15 shows an interactive visualization related to motion of a user on a first embodiment of a software application interface, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(34) FIG. 16A shows a first interactive visualization related to motion of the user on a second embodiment of the software application interface, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(35) FIG. 16B shows a second interactive visualization related to motion of the user on the second embodiment of the software application interface, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(36) FIG. 17 shows a three-dimensional skeletal output graph representing motion of the user on a third embodiment of the software application interface, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(37) FIG. 18A shows a first interactive visualization related to motion of the user on a fourth embodiment of the software application interface, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(38) FIG. 18B shows a second interactive visualization related to motion of the user on the fourth embodiment of the software application interface, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(39) FIG. 19 shows an interactive visualization related to motion of a user on a fifth embodiment of the software application interface, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(40) FIG. 20 shows a block diagram of a data analytics method performed by a motion analytics system having the sock of FIGS. 2A-2B and/or the insole layer of FIG. 4A, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(41) FIG. 21 shows a block diagram of a non-limiting example of a machine-learning architecture used by the data analytics method of FIG. 20, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

(42) The present disclosure is susceptible to various modifications and alternative forms, and some representative embodiments have been shown by way of example in the drawings and will be described in detail herein. It should be understood, however, that the invention is not intended to be limited to the particular forms disclosed. Rather, the disclosure is to cover all modifications, equivalents, and alternatives falling within the spirit and scope of the invention as defined by the appended claims.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(43) Various embodiments are described with reference to the attached figures, where like reference numerals are used throughout the figures to designate similar or equivalent elements. The figures are not necessarily drawn to scale and are provided merely to illustrate aspects and features of the present disclosure. Numerous specific details, relationships, and methods are set forth to provide a full understanding of certain aspects and features of the present disclosure, although one having ordinary skill in the relevant art will recognize that these aspects and features can be practiced without one or more of the specific details, with other relationships, or with other methods. In some instances, well-known structures or operations are not shown in detail for illustrative purposes. The various embodiments disclosed herein are not necessarily limited by the illustrated ordering of acts or events, as some acts may occur in different orders and/or concurrently with other acts or events. Furthermore, not all illustrated acts or events are necessarily required to implement certain aspects and features of the present disclosure.

(44) For purposes of the present detailed description, unless specifically disclaimed, and where appropriate, the singular includes the plural and vice versa. The word “including” means “including without limitation.” Moreover, words of approximation, such as “about,” “almost,” “substantially,” “approximately,” and the like, can be used herein to mean “at,” “near,” “nearly at,” “within 3-5% of,” “within acceptable manufacturing tolerances of,” or any logical combination thereof. Similarly, terms “vertical” or “horizontal” are intended to additionally include “within 3-5% of” a vertical or horizontal orientation, respectively. Additionally, words of direction, such as “top,” “bottom,” “left,” “right,” “above,” and “below” are intended to relate to the equivalent direction as depicted in a reference illustration; as understood contextually from the object(s) or element(s) being referenced, such as from a commonly used position for the object(s) or element(s); or as otherwise described herein. Further, it is noted that the term “signal” means a waveform (e.g., electrical, optical, magnetic, mechanical or electromagnetic) capable of traveling through a medium such as DC, AC, sinusoidal-wave, triangular-wave, square-wave, vibration, and the like.

(45) Embodiments of the disclosure are directed to an insole layer for monitoring human lower limb and foot performance. The insole layer includes a number of sensors including force-sensitive resistors distributed across a front portion, a middle portion, and a rear portion thereof, as well as three-axis accelerometers, three-axis gyroscopes, magnetometers, electromyography sensors, and the like. These sensors, as well as the sensors on the sock are configured to generate data associated with the motion of the user. The data may be encrypted and uploaded to a block chain, or an external computing device. The external computing device performs a data analytics routine to provide output data for context and insight on the motion to the user. The output of the data analytics routine may be used to present interactive visualizations on the motion of the user, as well as provide a predictive feedback on the motion of the feet of the user. The predictive feedback may be determined by a machine learning algorithm. Various beneficial features of the sock, the insole layer, and the data analytics method are discussed below, or will become obvious in light thereof.

(46) Referring to the drawings, FIG. 1 is a schematic representation of a motion analytics system **100** having a footwear device with one or more sensors. In the non-limiting embodiment depicted in FIG. 1, the footwear device is a sock **110** with an insole layer **120** having sensors for capturing motion data of a user. The sock **110** includes an electronic pad **115**, which is configured to protect a shin bone of the user and may include any number of sensors for capturing motion data of the user. In different embodiments, the footwear device may include only the insole layer **120**, or only the sock **110** with a number of sensors but without the insole layer **120**. In the embodiment shown in FIG. 1, the sock **110** with the electronic pad **115** and the insole layer **120** is placed over a charging module **130** to charge a power supply device in the insole layer **120** and/or the sock **110**. Various embodiments and features of the sock **110** and the insole layer **120** are described in further detail below.

(47) In some embodiments, the motion data may be continuous time series data, while in others, the motion data may be discrete in nature obtained at predetermined time intervals. The sock **110** and/or the insole layer **120** are individually capable of and configured to process and/or upload motion data generated by the sensors therein, to an external computing device **140**, a user computing device **150**, or a block chain **170**. In non-limiting examples, processing of the motion data includes pre-processing, sorting, filtering, compiling, encrypting, decrypting the data as well as computing parameters, statistics, metrics, analytics, etc. using the motion data. Such processing of the motion data may also be performed by the external computing device **140** or the user computing device **150**, preferably with the aid of a remote machine learning processor **160**.

(48) The sock **110** is connected to the external computing device **140** through a first communication channel A, while the insole layer **120** is connected to the external computing device **140** through a second communication channel B. The external computing device **140** is connected to the block chain **170** by a third communication channel C, and to the user computing device **150** by a fourth communication channel D. The external computing device **140** is connected to the

remote machine learning processor **160** by a fifth communication channel E, while the user computing device **150** is connected to the remote machine learning processor **160** by a sixth communication channel F. All communication channels A, B, C, D, E, and F are bidirectional in nature, though in some embodiments, as shown in FIG. **1**, the communication channels A and B may be unidirectional. In preferred embodiments, any one or any combination of the communication channels A, B, C, D, E, and F form a network that may include one or more cellular networks, satellite networks and/or computer networks such as, for example, a wide area network, a local area network, personal area network, a global positioning system and combinations thereof. Suitable local area networks may include wired Ethernet and/or wireless technologies such as, for example, wireless fidelity (Wi-Fi). Suitable personal area networks may include wireless technologies such as, for example, IrDA, Bluetooth, Wireless USB, Z-Wave, ZigBee, and/or other near field communication protocols. Suitable cellular networks include, but are not limited to, technologies such as LTE, WiMAX, UMTS, CDMA, and GSM.

(49) The external computing device **140** includes a processor **142** and a memory device **144** coupled to the processor **142**. The processor **142** is configured to receive and store the motion data generated by the sock **110** and/or the insole layer **120** through the communication channels A and/or B respectively. The memory device **144** is a non-transitory processor-readable memory and has a machine-readable instruction set for execution by the processor **142** to perform a data analytics method such as, but not limited to, the data analytics method **2000** discussed with respect to FIG. **20** below.

(50) The processor **142** may be any device capable of executing the machine-readable instruction set (e.g., represented by the block diagram of FIG. **20**) stored in the non-transitory computer-readable memory device **144**. Accordingly, the processor **142** may be an electronic controller, an integrated circuit, a microcontroller, a programmable chip device, a computer, or any other computing device.

(51) The memory device **144** may comprise RAM, ROM, flash memories, hard drives, or any non-transitory memory device capable of storing a machine-readable instruction set which can be accessed and executed by the processor **142**. The machine-readable instruction set may comprise logic or algorithm(s) written in any programming language of any generation (e.g., 1GL, 2GL, 3GL, 4GL, or 5GL) such as, for example, machine language that may be directly executed by the processor **142**, or assembly language, object-oriented programming (OOP), scripting languages, microcode, etc., that may be compiled or assembled into machine-readable instructions and stored in the non-transitory computer-readable memory device **144**. Alternatively, the machine-readable instruction set may be written in a hardware description language (HDL), such as logic implemented via either a field-programmable gate array (FPGA) configuration or an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or their equivalents. Accordingly, the functionality described herein may be implemented in any conventional computer programming language, as pre-programmed hardware elements, or as a combination of hardware and software components. While the embodiment depicted in FIG. **1** includes a single memory device **144**, other embodiments may include more than one memory device.

(52) The user computing device **150** includes a display **156**, as well as a processor and a memory device that are functionally similar to those of the external computing device **140**. The display **156** is configured to present interactive visualizations and output data relating to a predictive feedback on the motion of the user. The visualizations and predictive feedback are based on the motion data generated by the sock **110** and/or the insole layer **120**. The display **156** may include any medium capable of transmitting a visual output such as, for example, a cathode ray tube, light emitting diodes, liquid crystal displays, plasma displays, or the like. Additionally, the display **156** can be a touch screen that, in addition to providing visual information, detects the presence and location of a tactile input upon a surface of or adjacent to the display and thus provides an input device for a user. Accordingly, the display **156** can receive mechanical input directly upon the optical output

provided by the display **156**.

(53) The remote machine learning processor **160** is configured to process large amounts of data generated by the sock **110** and/or the insole layer **120** through one or more machine learning algorithms to detect patterns, classify features, and determine one or more predictive feedbacks from user motion. The predictive feedbacks may include information related to any one or any combination of symmetrical distribution of forces on the feet of the user during a motion, likelihood of injury of the user, one or more patterns of injury of the user, a recommended course of action to prevent an injury to the user, among others. The machine learning algorithms may include supervised learning, unsupervised learning, semi-supervised learning, human-in-the-loop learning, reinforcement learning, support vector machine, cluster analysis, hierarchical clustering, anomaly detection, deep learning, convolutional neural networks, and the like. For example, a predictive feedback may be learned from a training data set with motion data and the resulting output. In some embodiments, the motion data generated by the sock **110** and/or the insole layer **120**, as well as the processed and analyzed data may be securely stored in the block chain **170**. This ensures that the raw motion data and the processed and analyzed motion data are stored as an unfalsifiable, traceable, and time-stamped permanent record of motion of the user. Of course other security measures may be taken such as unique passwords, digital encryption, public/private key signature authentication and the like.

(54) FIG. 2A is a perspective view showing a first embodiment of the sock **110** for capturing motion data of a user. The sock **110** includes a sock enclosure **210** formed from an elastic composite synthetic fabric. In some embodiments, the elastic composite synthetic fabric is Spandex™, or Revolutionary™ by Carvico. Spandex™ is a lightweight polyether-polyurea copolymer and has high elasticity. Revolutionary™ is an ultra-thin and breathable synthetic fiber made from micro polyamide and elastane, and is ultraviolet (UV) protective, as well as resistant to chlorine, pilling, sand, and wear and tear. The sock enclosure **210** has a shin portion **212**, a calf portion **214**, and a foot portion **216**.

(55) The sock **110** includes one or more sensors for capturing the motion data of a user wearing the sock **110**. Each of these sensors may be disposed within a biosignal channel **218** of the sock enclosure **210**. As a non-limiting example, there may be biosignal channels **218** positioned at a central location and at lower heel-adjacent location along the calf portion **214**, as shown in FIGS. 2A-2B. An electromyography (EMG) sensor **215** may be disposed within each of these two biosignal channels **218** along the calf portion **214**. The EMG sensors **215** detect physiological data associated with electrical activity produced by one or more leg muscles corresponding to their position along the calf portion **214** and therefore can determine activation of one or more leg muscles, as well as fatigue occurring within such leg muscles.

(56) The sock **110** may include a heart rate sensor **211** and an inertial sensor **213** disposed along the shin portion **212**, and a temperature sensor **217** disposed along the foot portion **216**. The heart rate sensor **211** is configured to detect a heart rate of the user while wearing the sock **110**. The inertial sensor **213** is configured to detect motion data associated with translational and rotational motion of the shin of the user, while using the sock **110**. The temperature sensor **217** is configured to detect temperature in the legs of user, while wearing the sock **110**. The sock **110** may further include one or more inertial sensors **219** disposed laterally along the foot portion **216**. The inertial sensors **213** and **219** detect motion data associated with translational and rotational motion of the legs and feet of the user respectively, and hence relates to forces produced by the one or more leg muscles and feet of the user. In the non-limiting embodiment shown in FIG. 2A, the insole layer **120** is insertable into and disposed along the foot portion **216** of the sock enclosure **210**. As described below, the insole layer **120** includes one or more sensors for capturing different aspects of the user's motion.

(57) FIG. 2B is a perspective view showing a second embodiment of the sock **110** for capturing motion data of a user. In addition to the insole layer **120**, the sock **110** includes the electronic pad

115 disposed adjacent to the shin portion **212**. The electronic pad **115** is communicatively connected to the insole layer **120**. The electronic pad **115** includes the heart rate sensor **211** and the inertial sensor **213** embedded therein, in addition to other sensors. The sock **110** has the sock enclosure **210** with a shin portion **212**, a calf portion **214**, and a foot portion **216**. The sock **110** includes one or more sensors that are each disposed within a biosignal channel **218** of the sock enclosure **210**. These sensors may include the two or more electromyography (EMG) sensors **215** disposed along the calf portion **214**, as well as the temperature sensor **217** and the inertial sensors **219** disposed laterally along the foot portion **216**.

(58) FIG. 3 is a front view showing the electronic pad **115** in FIG. 2A disposed adjacent to the shin portion **212** on the sock **110**. The electronic pad **115** includes a flexible printed circuit board (PCB) **310** on which one or more sensors (e.g., the heart rate sensor **211**, the inertial sensor **213**) are embedded. Other components such as memory devices, a transceiver, and a network interface may be fabricated on the flexible PCB **310**. The flexible PCB **310** may be formed from a glass-reinforced epoxy laminate material such as, but not limited to, FR-4. A processor **312** is disposed on the flexible PCB **310** and configured to receive motion data generated by the sensors and perform pre-processing operations on the raw data. A power supply device **314** such as, but not limited to, an ultra-thin rechargeable lithium polymer battery is also electrically connected therein to provide electrical power to the sensors, the memory devices, the transceiver, and the processor **312**. In some embodiments, the flexible PCB **310** may include a charging socket (not shown) for charging the power supply device **314** by direct current (DC) charging, as well as a router device (not shown) for enabling wireless internet communication. Additionally or alternatively, in some embodiments, the flexible PCB **310** may include a radio-frequency (RF) transmitting antenna and a RF receiving antenna (not shown) for bidirectional RF communication from the transceiver that enables both wireless charging of the power supply device **314** and data exchange with the external computing device **140** shown in FIG. 1.

(59) FIGS. 4A-4D represent a perspective view, top view, side view, and bottom view, respectively, of the insole layer **120**. In some embodiments, the insole layer **120** has low thickness of between about 0.2 mm and about 0.6 mm, and shaped to be placed inside a shoe (e.g., a military boot, an athletic shoe such as a shoe for soccer, basketball, baseball, running, tennis and the like), a sock (e.g., the sock **110**, a regular sock), or under an existing insole of a shoe. In some embodiments, the insole layer **120** has a shape corresponding to a known shoe size (e.g., 9, 9.5, 10, 10.5, 11, 11.5, etc.). In some embodiments, the insole layer **120** has a shape customized to correspond to a user's foot such that any load sensing areas correspond to pressure points on the foot of the user, for maximum comfort.

(60) The insole layer **120** has a top cover layer **410** and a bottom cover layer **420**. The top cover layer **410** and the bottom cover layer **420** are water-resistant and designed to protect a flexible PCB **430** disposed between the top cover layer **410** and the bottom cover layer **420**. In some embodiments, the top cover layer **410** and the bottom cover layer **420** are formed from a water-resistant polyester material and may include a silicon conformal coating. The top cover layer **410** has a slippery upper surface **411** and a slip-resistant lower surface **419** (shown in FIG. 5). The bottom cover layer **420** has a slippery upper surface **421** (not shown) and a slip-resistant lower surface **429**. In some embodiments, the slip-resistant lower surfaces **419** and **429** may be formed by a thin rubber layer disposed under each of the top cover layer **410** and the bottom cover layer **420** respectively.

(61) The flexible PCB **430** is substantially similar to the flexible PCB **310** of the electronic pad **115** and made from a glass-reinforced epoxy laminate material such as, but not limited to, epoxy. The flexible PCB **430** has an upper surface **431**, a lower surface **439**, a front portion **432**, a middle portion **434**, and a rear portion **436**. A central enclosure **440** for accommodating electronic circuits and devices embedded on the flexible PCB **430** is disposed along the middle portion **434**, while a charging socket **433** is disposed along the rear portion **436** of the flexible PCB **430**. The flexible

PCB **430** further includes a power supply device **438** disposed along the upper surface **431** over the middle portion **434**. In non-limiting embodiments, the power supply device **438** may be an ultra-thin rechargeable lithium polymer battery. The lower surface **439** of the flexible PCB **430** may also include a charging socket frame **437** for accommodating a DC charging system (e.g., shown in FIG. **12A**) that charges the power supply device **438** through the charging socket **433**.

(62) Multiple sensing areas **435** are distributed adjacent to or along the lower surface **439** of the flexible PCB **430**. The sensing areas **435** are each configured to help detect motion and load delivered to and by a user therethrough. The distribution of the sensing areas **435** may be based on commonly known pressure points on a foot or alternatively, customized to correspond with pressure points on the foot of a user based on known physical activity demands of the user. As a non-limiting example, the sensing areas **435** may be grouped in areas that experience the highest load, such as between the first and fifth metatarsal bones and the heel bones. In non-limiting examples, there are nine sensing areas **435a-435i** on each insole layer **120** (e.g., as shown in FIG. **4D**), but greater or fewer sensing areas may be placed on the insole layer **120**. In the non-limiting embodiment of FIG. **4D**, the sensing area **435a** is positioned adjacent to the big toe of the foot on the front portion **432**; the sensing area **435b-435d** are positioned on a medial forefoot section of the inner arch of the foot on the front portion **432**; the sensing area **435e** is positioned on a medial forefoot section of the outer arch of the foot on the front portion **432**; the sensing area **435f** is positioned on a lateral forefoot section of the outer arch of the foot on the front portion **432**; the sensing area **435g** is positioned on a mid-heel section of the foot on the rear portion **436**; the sensing area **435h** is positioned on a lateral heel section of the foot on the rear portion **436**; and the sensing area **435i** is positioned on a medial-heel section of the foot on the rear portion **436**.

(63) FIG. **5** is an exploded bottom perspective view of the insole layer **120**. The insole layer **120** has the top cover layer **410** with the upper surface **411** and the lower surface **419**. The flexible PCB **430** having the front portion **432**, the middle portion **434**, and the rear portion **436** is disposed under the top cover layer **410**. The flexible PCB **430** also includes a front sensor module **510** and a rear sensor module **520** disposed along the lower surface **439** of the flexible PCB **430** and adjacent to or along the front portion **432** and the rear portion **436** respectively. In this example, the front sensor module **510** includes the sensing areas **435a-435f** described above, while the rear sensor module **520** includes the sensing areas **435g-435i** described above. The bottom cover layer **420** with the upper surface **421** and the lower surface **429** is disposed under the front sensor module **510** and the rear sensor module **520**.

(64) The charging socket frame **437**, and an attachment bracket **550** disposed through the charging socket frame **437** are disposed adjacent to the bottom cover layer **420**. The attachment bracket **550** is configured to accommodate magnetic attachments **555** of a DC charging station **1220** (shown in FIG. **12B**), and is described in further detail below with respect to FIGS. **9A-9B**. The bottom cover layer **420** also includes holes **425** for accommodating each of the plurality of sensing areas **435**.

(65) The front sensor module **510** and the rear sensor module **520** are covered by a front adhesive film **590** and a rear adhesive film **595** respectively. The front adhesive film **590** and the rear adhesive film **595** are disposed between the flexible PCB **430** and the bottom cover layer **420**. In some embodiments, the front adhesive film **590** and the rear adhesive film **595** may be a slip-resistant layer of ethylene propylene diene monomer (EPDM) foam having thickness between about 0.2 mm and about 1.2 mm. The front sensor module **510** and the rear sensor module **520** are described in further detail with respect to FIGS. **7A-7B**.

(66) The front sensor module **510** and the rear sensor module **520** include one or more ventilation openings **710** (FIGS. **7A-7B**) for ventilating the sensors therein. Each ventilation opening **710** is covered by a waterproof membrane **580**, as further discussed and shown with respect to FIG. **8**.

(67) Both the front sensor module **510** and the rear sensor module **520** include multiple sensing areas **435**. Each sensing area **435** includes a puck-shaped load concentrator **570** encapsulated within a protective adhesive film **575**. The load concentrators **570** have force-sensitive resistors

therein that can measure load applied to the location on the foot where the sensing area is located. The load concentrators **570** can have different thicknesses for different areas of the foot. For example, the load concentrators adjacent to the rear portion **436** may have a greater thickness than the load concentrators **570** in the metatarsal area adjacent to the middle portion **434**.

(68) The flexible PCB **430** includes a motion-tracking device **532**, a processor **536**, and the power supply device **438** and other electrical components. The motion-tracking device **532** is electronically connected to or includes sensors that detect motion of a user. These sensors include the force-sensitive resistors described above that change resistance upon application of a force, as well as three-axis accelerometers for measuring acceleration and g-forces, three-axis gyroscopes for measuring rotation and angular velocity, magnetometers for measuring trajectory and direction of heading, temperature sensors for measuring temperature of the foot, electromyography sensors for measuring muscle activation and fatigue, and heart sensors for measuring heart rate, all of which measure various physical and physiological parameters of the user. In some embodiments, the three-axis accelerometers include at least one high-G accelerometer. The distribution of sensing points for the force-sensitive resistors may be based on commonly known pressure points on feet or alternatively, customized to correspond with pressure points on the foot of a user based on known physical activity demands of the user. For example, the force-sensitive resistors may have sensing points directly under the heel of the user in the rear portion **436** in order to capture data on translational and rotational motion from an area which experiences a high range of motion. In some embodiments, the force-sensitive resistors are replaceable devices that can be installed after peeling off a sensor cover.

(69) In some embodiments, the force-sensitive resistors have a measuring frequency of about 300 Hz, sensitivity of about 1 Newton, and accuracy of about ± 3 Newtons. In some embodiments, the three-axis accelerometers have a measuring frequency of about 300 Hz, a range between about ± 2 -16 G, and a sensitivity of about 0.06-0.48 mG. In some embodiments, the high-G accelerometers have a measuring frequency of about 300 Hz, a range between about ± 100 -400 G, and a sensitivity of about 49-195 mG. In some embodiments, the three-axis gyroscopes have a measuring frequency of about 300 Hz, a range between about ± 250 -2000 dps, and a sensitivity of about 7.6-61 mdps. In some embodiments, the magnetometers have a measuring frequency of about 300 Hz, a range between about ± 4900 uT, and a sensitivity of about 0.15 uT. In some embodiments, the temperature sensor in the motion-tracking device **532** is substantially similar to the temperature sensor **217**, and measures temperature at frequency of 1 Hz with a sensitivity of about 1 Celsius.

(70) The processor **536** is substantially similar to the processor **142** discussed above. The processor **536** is configured to receive motion data generated by the sensors in the motion-tracking device **532**. In a non-limiting example, the processor **536** is a microcontroller having built-in wireless capabilities.

(71) The power supply device **438** is electrically coupled to the motion-tracking device **532** and the processor **536**. The power supply device **438** is encapsulated within an adhesive film **537** for protection. The power supply device **438** is configured to power the motion-tracking device **532**, the processor **536**, and any electrical and electronic devices embedded in the flexible PCB **430**.

(72) The central enclosure **440** is disposed along the middle portion **434** of the flexible PCB **430** for housing the motion-tracking device **532**, the power supply device **438**, the processor **536**, and other electronic circuits and devices. The central enclosure **440** has an upper frame **542**, a lower frame **544**, and a covering plate **546** coupled to the lower frame **544**. The upper frame **542** and the lower frame **544** are covered with a protective fabric **540a** and a protective fabric **540b** respectively. A layer of potting material **545** such as, but not limited to, epoxy resin is disposed within the lower frame **544** and between the covering plate **546** and the flexible PCB **430**.

(73) FIGS. **6A-6D** represent a bottom perspective view, a top perspective view, a bottom view, and a side view, respectively, of the flexible PCB **430** disposed within the insole layer **120**. While various features and embodiments of the flexible PCB **430** are already discussed above, FIGS. **6A-**

6D provide additional features and perspectives of the flexible PCB 430. The power supply device 438 is disposed adjacent to or along the upper surface 431 in the middle portion 434 of the flexible PCB 430, while the charging socket 433 is disposed on the upper surface 431 in the rear portion 436 of the flexible PCB 430. The charging socket 433 is configured to charge the power supply device 438 by DC charging. The sensing areas 435 are distributed on the lower surface 439 of the flexible PCB 430 based on pressure points on the foot of a user, as shown in FIGS. 6C-6D.

(74) The central enclosure 440 (shown in FIGS. 4A-4D, and FIG. 6D) is disposed adjacent to or along the lower surface 439 in the middle portion 434 of the flexible PCB 430. The central enclosure 440 houses the motion-tracking device 532 having the plurality of sensors described above, as well as the processor 536 discussed above, a memory device 535, a router device 534, and an energy-harvesting device 538. The energy-harvesting device 538 is configured to convert the kinetic energy generated through movement of the insole layer 120 into electrical energy for charging the power supply device 438.

(75) The memory device 535 is a non-transitory processor-readable memory device that is substantially similar to the memory device 144. In the non-limiting example of FIGS. 4A-6D, the memory device 535 is a flash NAND memory device having at least 128 MB of storage. The memory device 535 stores machine-readable instructions that when executed by the processor 536 causes the processor 536 to encrypt the motion data generated from the motion-tracking device 532 using an Advanced Encryption Standard (AES), and then upload the encrypted data to the block chain 170, or the external computing device 140 and/or the user computing device 150. Additionally, the machine-readable instructions may cause the processor 536 to download data from the external computing device 140 and/or the user computing device 150 and decrypt the downloaded data.

(76) The motion data generated by the motion-tracking device 532 may be used by the processor 536, the external computing device 140, and/or the user computing device 150 to present interactive visualizations on the motion of the user and/or provide predictive feedback on the motion of the feet of the user, determined by a supervised or an unsupervised algorithm based on the motion data. Further, the insole layer 120 can be diagnosed remotely from the external computing device 140 and/or the user computing device 150 using diagnostic data uploaded and downloaded over the wireless communication channels described above.

(77) The router device 534 may include an antenna, a modem, a LAN port, wireless fidelity (Wi-Fi) card, WiMax card, ZigBee card, Bluetooth chip, USB card, mobile communications hardware, and/or other hardware for communicating with other networks and/or devices. The router device 534 enables wireless internet communication between the insole layer 120 and an external device such as the external computing device 140, the user computing device 150, the electronic pad 115 on the sock 110, a compression vest, a wearable device worn by the user such as those made by Apple, Garmin, FitBit, etc. In the non-limiting example of FIGS. 4A-6D, the router device 534 is a 4G/5G IoT (Internet-of-things) modem, which provides low-power operation in an always-connected state (at less than 2 milli amperes of current) and can provide encrypted data uploads many times per day. When the insole layer 120 is operational in remote locations where there is no cellular signal, the motion data can be uploaded using a local Bluetooth network, or may be stored in the memory device 535 until better wireless connection is available.

(78) Additionally, the central enclosure 440 of the flexible PCB 430 may include supporting electronic devices and circuits such as, but not limited to, a charger for recharging the power supply device 438, a DC/DC switching regulator for converting DC power of the power supply device 438 to system power, one or more voltage regulators, a radio-frequency (RF) antenna, a battery protector, a supervisor for the processor 536, and the like.

(79) The flexible PCB 430 further includes a number of physical features. These include one or more cutout portions 610 to accommodate the one or more magnetic attachments 555 of a DC charging station 1220 (shown in FIG. 12B), one or more conductive surfaces/traces 630 for spring-

loaded connection pins of the DC charging station **1220**, one or more holes **620** to accommodate guide pins of the DC charging station **1220**, a cluster of perforations **660** in the middle portion **434** for incorporating the layer of potting material **545**, and a series of apertures **670** around a perimeter of the middle portion **434** for positioning the central enclosure **440**. Further, the flexible PCB **430** includes kerf bend cuts **640** forming a concave shape around the rear portion **436** of the flexible PCB **430**, which results in high transverse flexibility perpendicular to the concave contour; kerf bend cuts **650** for separating the central enclosure **440** from the rear portion **436**, which results in high longitudinal flexibility; and kerf bend cuts **680** for enabling longitudinal bending of the front portion **432** of the flexible PCB **430**, which results in very high longitudinal and medium transverse flexibility. The kerf bend cuts **640**, **650**, and **680** allow the FR-4 material of the flexible PCB **430** to be used as a current carrier through the incessant translational, rotational, and shearing movement of the insole layer **120**. Additionally, the kerf bend cuts **640**, **650**, and **680** allow the insole layer **120** to take the shape of the footwear it is placed in, which creates tighter fitting and more precise measurement of motion by the sensors.

(80) FIG. 6D shows a cross-sectional view of the insole layer **120** along the line 6D-6D' in FIG. 6C, showing the various layers of the middle portion **434** stacked over one another from the bottom to the top. FIG. 6D shows an inset I showing the specific layers of the middle portion **434**. The covering plate **546** is stacked under the layer of potting material **545**, which is stacked under the lower frame **544**. The lower frame **544** is stacked under the flexible PCB **430**, which is stacked under the power supply device **438**, which is stacked under the upper frame **542**.

(81) FIG. 7A is a bottom perspective view showing the front sensor module **510** of the flexible PCB **430**. The front sensor module **510** includes one or more sensing areas **435**, connection pins **730a**, traces **790** connecting the sensing areas **435** with the connection pins **730a**, and one or more ventilation openings **710** that provide ventilation to the sensors of the flexible PCB **430**. The connection pins **730a** are configured to connect with the central enclosure **440** (FIGS. 4A-4D and FIG. 5). The sensing areas **435** and the ventilation openings **710** are dispersed on a film laminate **750a** that protects the flexible PCB **430** against tearing.

(82) FIG. 7B is a bottom perspective view showing the rear sensor module **520** of the flexible PCB **430**. The rear sensor module **520** includes one or more sensing areas **435**, connection pins **730b**, traces **790** connecting the sensing areas **43** with the connection pins **730b**, one or more ventilation openings **710** and a cutout **720** for the attachment bracket **550** of the bottom cover layer **420**. The connection pins **730b** are configured to connect with the central enclosure **440**. The sensing areas **435** and the ventilation openings **710** are dispersed on a film laminate **750b** that protects the flexible PCB **430** against tearing.

(83) FIG. 8 is perspective view of one of the waterproof membranes **580** in FIG. 5. The waterproof membrane **580** covers one of the ventilation openings **710** in the front sensor module **510** and the rear sensor module **520**. Each waterproof membrane **580** includes an open area **830** surrounded by an upper wall **810**, a lower wall **820**, and a sidewall **840**. The open area **830** is placed over one of the ventilation openings **710** in the front sensor module **510** and the rear sensor module **520**.

(84) FIGS. 9A-9B represent a top perspective view and a bottom perspective view, respectively, showing the attachment bracket **550** on the bottom cover layer **420**. The attachment bracket **550** has a top surface **951** and a bottom surface **959**. A number of pins **956** are dispersed around a perimeter of the bottom surface **959**. The pins **956** aid in positioning and locking the attachment bracket **550** to the bottom cover layer **420**. The attachment bracket **550** further includes one or more cutouts **954** for placing the magnetic attachments **555** of the DC charging station **1220** (shown in FIG. 12B) and one or more through-holes **952** to accommodate guide pins of the DC charging station **1220**.

(85) FIGS. 10A-10B represent a bottom perspective view and a top perspective view, respectively, showing the upper frame **542** of the central enclosure **440** that covers the power supply device **438**. The upper frame **542** has a top surface **1041** and a bottom surface **1049**. The upper frame **542**

includes one or more cut-outs **1010** for terminals of the power supply device **438**, as well as a support edge **1020** to accommodate a thinner section of the power supply device **438**. The upper frame **542** further includes a number of pins **1030** dispersed around a perimeter of the bottom surface **1049**, which aid in positioning the upper frame **542** with the lower frame **544** and connecting with the flexible PCB **430**.

(86) FIGS. **10C-10D** represent a bottom perspective view and a top perspective view, respectively, showing the lower frame **544** of the central enclosure **440** that covers the electronic circuits and devices therein. The lower frame **544** has a top surface **1051** and a bottom surface **1059**. The lower frame **544** includes one or more cut-outs **1060** for connection pins **730a** of the front sensor module **510**, one or more cut-outs **1070** for connection pins **730b** of the rear sensor module **520**, and a cut-out **1090** for pouring in potting material to form the layer of potting material **545**. The lower frame **544** further includes a number of pins **1080** dispersed around a perimeter of the top surface **1051**, which aid in positioning the lower frame **544** with the upper frame **542** and connecting with the flexible PCB **430**.

(87) As described above, the insole layer **120** has a rechargeable power supply device **438**. system, or a direct current (DC) charging system. FIG. **11A** is a block diagram of the wireless RF charging system for the insole layer **120**. One or more insole layers **120** can be positioned on or adjacent to a charging rack **1150** such that an RF antenna in the insole layer **120** can receive RF transmission for wireless charging. The charging rack serves as a base station that is also wirelessly connected to the external computing device **140** (e.g., by a wireless internet connection) **140** and to the user computing device **150** (e.g., by a Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) connection, wireless internet connection, etc.). This enables the insole layer **120** to upload motion data generated by the sensors, while the power supply device **438** is recharging.

(88) FIG. **11B** is a bottom perspective view showing the flexible PCB **430** having electronics associated with the wireless RF charging system of FIG. **11A**. The flexible PCB **430** has an RF plate **1110** with an embedded RF transmitting antenna **1112** and an embedded RF receiving antenna **1114**. The RF plate **1110** is electrically connected to an RF chip **1120** embedded in the layer of potting material **545** through connection lines **1115**. The RF transmitting antenna **1112** and the RF receiving antenna **1114** are configured for bidirectional communication that enables both data exchange with the external computing device **140** and/or the user computing device **150**, as well as wireless charging of the power supply device **438**.

(89) FIG. **12A** is a block diagram of the DC charging system for the insole layer **120**. One or more insole layers **120** can be positioned on the charging rack **1150** such that DC current can charge the power supply device **438** through the charging socket **433**. In the non-limiting example of FIG. **12A**, the charging rack **1150** includes more than one DC charging station **1220** (FIG. **12B**), each of which is configured to be coupled to the insole layer **120** through one or more magnetic attachments **555**. The charging rack **1150** is also wirelessly connected to the external computing device **140** (e.g., by a wireless internet connection) **140** and to the user computing device **150** (e.g., by a Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) connection). This enables the insole layer **120** to upload motion data generated by the sensors, while the power supply device **438** is recharging.

(90) FIG. **12B** is a top perspective view showing a DC charging apparatus **1200** including a DC charging station **1220** for charging the insole layer **120**. As shown in FIG. **12B**, the insole layer **120** can be charged by direct contact (e.g., through the magnetic attachments **555**) to the DC charging station **1220** or by a charging cable **1210** that connects a DC outlet **1225** (shown in FIG. **12C**) of the DC charging station **1220** to the charging socket **433** of the insole layer **120**.

(91) FIG. **12C** is a top perspective view of the DC charging station **1220**. The DC charging station **1220** includes two DC outlets **1225** within a housing **1222**. As shown in the inlet of FIG. **12C**, each DC outlet **1225** includes a magnetic attachment of first polarity **1224a** and a magnetic attachment of second polarity **1224b** that are configured to be secured to the attachment bracket **550** of the insole layer **120**. Each DC outlet **1225** further includes guide pins **1226** and spring-loaded

connection pins **1228** for delivering DC current to the insole layer **120**, while the insole layer **120** remains secured by the magnetic attachments **1224a**, **1224b**. The guide pins **1226** are configured to be accommodated through the holes **620** on the flexible PCB **430**, shown in FIG. **6A**. The spring-loaded connection pins **1228** are configured to be accommodated through the conductive surfaces/traces **630** on the flexible PCB **430**, as shown in FIG. **6A**.

(92) FIG. **12D** is a top perspective exploded view showing the DC charging apparatus **1200**. When the insole layer **120** is charged using the charging cable **1210**, a female connector **1215a** of the charging cable **1210** connects with the DC outlet **1225** on the DC charging station **1220**, while a male connector **1215b** of the charging cable **1210** connects with the charging socket **433** on the flexible PCB **430** of the insole layer **120**. On the other hand, when the insole layer **120** is charged wirelessly, the charging socket **433** adjacent to the top cover layer **410** (FIGS. **4A-4D**) is placed directly over the DC outlet **1225**, and the charging socket frame **437** adjacent to the bottom cover layer **420** remains viewable.

(93) FIG. **12E** is a perspective view showing the charging cable **1210** of the DC charging apparatus **1200**. The female connector **1215a** of the charging cable **1210** includes a magnetic attachment of first polarity **1212a** and a magnetic attachment of second polarity **1212b** that are configured to be secured to the magnetic attachments **1224a** and **1224b**, respectively, of the DC outlet **1225**. The female connector **1215a** further includes one or more holes **1214** for accommodating guide pins **1226** of the DC outlet **1225**, and one or more conductive surfaces/traces **1217** for accommodating spring-loaded connection pins **1228** of the DC outlet **1225**.

(94) The male connector **1215b** of the charging cable **1210** includes a magnetic attachment of first polarity **1212a** and a magnetic attachment of second polarity **1212b** that are configured to be secured to the attachment bracket **550** of the insole layer **120**. The male connector **1215b** further includes guide pins **1216** and spring-loaded connection pins **1218** for delivering DC current to the insole layer **120**, while the insole layer **120** remains secured by the magnetic attachments **1212a**, **1212b**. The guide pins **1216** are configured to be accommodated through the holes **620** on the flexible PCB **430**, shown in FIG. **6A**. The spring-loaded connection pins **1218** are configured to be accommodated through the conductive surfaces/traces **630** on the flexible PCB **430**, as shown in FIG. **6A**.

(95) As noted above, the power supply device **438** of the insole layer **120** can be charged using either the wireless RF charging system shown in FIG. **11A**, the DC charging system shown in FIG. **12A**, or the both. Once the power supply device **438** is fully charged, the insole layer **120** remains dormant until one or more sensors, such as the force-sensitive resistors, the three-axis accelerometers, and the three-axis gyroscopes detect movement over a predetermined threshold value. Thus, the insole layer **120** becomes active only when the insole layer **120** detects a full body weight, resultant ground reaction forces being exerted, movement, and/or a change in direction. At that point, the sensors in the insole layer **120** begin collecting motion data of the user as a new session or a predesignated session. A session may be defined as a period of time where a user is involved in physical activity such as a training session, a clinical session, or open play such as a match. The session may be verified through other records of the session, which may be correlated with the data record. The session and data collection may be paused if the insole layer detects no movement for about 60-120 seconds, and then resumes as soon as movement is detected. The session ends when the insole layer **120** or footwear (e.g., a shoe, or the sock **110**) is placed on the charging rack **1150**.

(96) During a session, the combined data generated from the insole layer **120** is encrypted and uploaded in real-time via the router device **534**. In some embodiments, the encrypted data is automatically stored, processed and shared, on an open data-driven and permissioned block chain **170**. This provides a traceable, timestamped record of motion data from different sessions (e.g., from training, clinics, open play) that cannot be deleted or falsified. As a result, motion data of the user can become a living historical record, which can be accessed and shared with different parties

(e.g., medical provider, employer, family, coach) in a controlled fashion.

(97) The power supply device **438** of the insole layer **120** can be charged using the DC charging station **1220**, which can be a stationary rack module **1310** (shown in FIG. **13**) or a portable sleeve module **1410** (shown in FIG. **14**). FIG. **13** is a schematic representation of the process of charging the insole layer **120** using the stationary rack module **1310**. Each stationary rack module **1310** includes a DC charging station **1220**, on which the insole layer **120** or shoes **1305** with the insole layer **120** can be placed for charging. Multiple stationary rack modules **1310** can be placed on racks **1315** of a DC charging shelf **1320**, which can be used by many users simultaneously for charging the insole layer **120**.

(98) FIG. **14** is a schematic representation of the process of charging the insole layer **120** using the portable sleeve module **1410**. Each portable sleeve module **1410** is made of a foldable technical fabric such as, but not limited to, Acrylonitrile Butadiene Styrene (ABS), High-Impact Polystyrene (HIPS), High-Density Polyethylene (HDPE), Polyvinyl Chloride (PVC), Polyethylene Terephthalate (PET), Thermoplastic Polyolefin (TPO), and the like. Each portable sleeve module **1410** can have one or more DC charging stations **1220**, on which the insole layer **120** can be charged. Multiple portable sleeve modules **1410** can be placed on travel case **1420** for use during travel. In some embodiments, the travel case **1420** itself can be recharged through an independent power connection to a 12V power supply.

(99) The systems and methods of monitoring human lower limb and foot performance as described herein can be configured to provide time-stamped prescriptive and augmented analytics of the motion data generated from the sock **110**, the insole layer **120**, and any wearable device connected to them.

(100) The motion data is analyzed to determine three categories of metrics—load, force distribution, and gait using a load module, a force distribution module, and a gait module respectively in software executed by the processor **142**, the processor **312**, and/or the processor **536**. The load module calculates the force imparted to each insole layer **132** across the sensing areas **435** during the session, while each foot is in contact with the ground. Using a threshold-based algorithm and using both the force-sensitive resistor and inertial sensors described above, the load module determines both the initial contact (IC) and final contact (FC) points of the foot with the ground during the gait cycle.

(101) The force-sensitive resistors capture raw pressure data from each of the sensing areas **435** and transforms it into force data, via a force calibration algorithm. The force calibration algorithm approximates the ground reaction force during a gait from the motion data generated by the insole layer. The force calibration algorithm is trained by data captured from a variety of subjects and forms of footwear under a variety of stepping conditions using a piezo-electric force plate.

(102) The inertial sensors add more granularity to high-impact forces experienced by the user during IC with the ground during running and jumping motions. The load module uses both IC and FC points to provide temporal boundaries for subsequent calculations. The load metrics are determined through the output of the force calibration algorithm and analyzed by a subject matter expert, which provides the user with mechanical load data from the interaction of the foot with the ground.

(103) As a non-limiting example, load data is obtained from a group of athletes wearing insole layers **120** following a training session. Load data maybe collected hourly or daily, and used to calculate weekly, monthly and season load totals. This is termed ‘longitudinal load monitoring’. Athletes are monitored consistently, with special attention made to those who are recovering from injury, or have recently recovered from injury. Cumulative load ‘budgets’ are utilized to control the amount of load each athlete is subjected to during training and competing, over a given period of time. When athletes are at risk of exceeding their load ‘budget’ due to a training session exhibiting more load than planned/expected, subsequent training sessions can be modified in order to keep an athlete within their ‘budget’ and thereby mitigate the risk of injury.

(104) The force distribution module uses calibrated force data to calculate the force differences between left and right foot, as well as the differences between the various regions of each foot. Through the subject matter expert, force-sensitive resistors in the insole layer **120** captures data from the most relevant regions of the foot, providing insight into the loading pattern experienced by the user during the gait cycle. The regions of the foot are separated into rearfoot (heel), midfoot (middle) and forefoot (toward toes) to simplify insight and facilitate understanding. The characteristics of regional load distribution are presented to the user in simple terms to provide an objective measure of symmetry between left and right sides, as well as regions of each foot. The symmetry calculation is based on either force or impulse. One example of a symmetry calculation is a ratio between a difference and a sum of the measurements of the left foot and the right foot.

(105) As a non-limiting example, force distribution data is obtained from a group of athletes wearing the insole layers **120** following a training session. The data provides insight into the symmetry of movement of each athlete throughout the training session (i.e. the difference in load taken through the left and right foot). Symmetry data is collated longitudinally, allowing comparison between the data from a single training session and an athlete's 'symmetry average' over a period of time. When a particular athlete is found to have exhibited a symmetry measurement from a training session that differs significantly from their 'symmetry average', the athlete can be screened by medical staff to detect whether a new injury, or functional deficit, may be responsible for the change in symmetry. In this way, 'at risk' athletes can be screened following training, facilitating the application of corrective exercises or manual treatment, thereby mitigating the risk of injury resulting from subsequent training sessions

(106) The gait module uses both IC/FC points and calibrated force/impulse data to calculate metrics that provide more detailed insight into the gait strategy used by each user. This is higher-level information designed for use by the user or an experienced medical or athletic coach looking to understand the unique movements involved during the gait cycle, determine normal gait patterns for a given footwear/ground interface, diagnose issues causing pain and implement effective corrective exercise or treatment to correct abnormalities. Gait metrics can be separated into temporal, spatial, kinetic and kinematic categories.

(107) The gait module includes temporal metrics (based on time) that include, but are not limited to, contact time (time in which one foot is in contact with the ground), flight time (time in which neither foot is in contact with the ground during running), dual-support time (time in which both feet are in contact with the ground during walking), swing time (duration of the swing phase of the gait cycle), and duty factor (the ratio of contact time to the sum of contact and flight times, which is a measure of efficiency). Other temporal gait metrics include step frequency (number of steps per second or minute) and stride frequency (numbers of complete strides per second or minute).

(108) Spatial gait metrics include, but are not limited to, step length (distance covered during one step) and stride length (distance covered during one stride). Both of these metrics involve a calculation of speed which may be derived by a supervised machine learning process involving motion data captured by both the force-sensitive resistors and the inertial sensors described above.

(109) Kinetic gait metrics include peak and average forces in either the vertical, frontal or lateral plane, as well as representation of force angle and gait line (the path of force throughout the foot), derived from the force calibration algorithm previously discussed.

(110) Kinematic gait metrics include distance covered, movement speed, swing leg velocity, acceleration, and are all dependent on the modelling of speed from the sensor data.

(111) As a non-limiting example, gait data is obtained from an athlete wearing tech layers following a rehabilitation training session. The rehabilitation process can be informed in detail by utilizing gait metrics to understand the strategies employed by an athlete to execute a movement task. Throughout a rehabilitation period, following long-term injury or surgery, gait metrics can be used by the experienced practitioner to guide the progression of exercises they apply to the athlete. By comparing the gait metrics collected during a task that is performed post-injury with 'baseline'

gait metrics collected when performing the same task pre-injury, the practitioner is provided a means to assess an athlete's readiness for the task. In this example, use of gait data by a skilled practitioner, can significantly increase the likelihood of a successful rehabilitation period, enabling an athlete to safely return to the field of play in the shortest possible time.

(112) The prescriptive and augmented analytics may be viewed as interactive visualizations on a software application interface on the display **156** of the user computing device **150**. The software application may be used before, during, or after a session for a single athlete, or group of athletes. The software application is also used to mark one or more periods within a session, providing a means for the user to separate a session into meaningful portions and/or determine analytics based on any combination of the sensors, thereby enriching the insights available following analysis and the interactive visualizations based on the motion data. The software application may be used to capture and record video data corresponding to one or more periods of the session during which motion data is collected to facilitate a greater understanding of the motion data over time. The software application can also be used to switch collection of motion data between a “live” mode for livestreaming the motion data captured by the sensors during a session, and a “recall” mode for viewing recorded motion data associated with one or more periods of the session, which may be user-selected. This provides the user with information in real-time during a session and after a session, which generate insights into the ‘athlete load’, performance, and risk of injury. Further, the software application may provide the ability to overlay forces on the left foot and the right foot on a time base from the captured recording or livestream, visualize the data in different areas of the foot—sum the individual loads on the heel area, the lateral area, the medial area and the forefoot area on each insole layer **120**, or sum each of the entire insole layers on the left foot and the right foot, as well as related analytics such as average force, peak force, cumulative force, percent symmetry between left foot and right foot, contact time, flight time, etc.

(113) The interactive visualizations can occur both in real-time as well as a recorded feed after a session has been completed. In some embodiments, the interactive visualizations include motion graphics with force-time series data streamlined in real time. In some embodiments, the analytics may include average force, peak force, cumulative force, force-frequency profile, muscle activation level, contact time, etc. for different areas of each foot and leg, as selected by the user. Further, the analytics may include interplay between the different legs and feet such as, but not limited to, percent loading symmetry between left foot and right foot.

(114) Individual motion data sets from each of the sensors and wearable devices described above may be viewed separately or cumulatively, and combined with a video recording of the motion to gain in-depth insight into the movement of the user. An indication may be delivered when there is a threshold percentage change from base line values that suggest overloading or if overloading is being avoided.

(115) FIG. **15** shows a non-limiting example of an interactive visualization **1500** related to motion of a user **1510** on a first embodiment of a software application interface. The visualization **1500** includes metrics derived from motion data collected by the insole layer **120** worn by the user **1510**. The metrics may include a heat map of loading in different areas of the left foot **1512a** and the right foot **1512b** of the user **1510**, and gait features such as step rate, contact time, stride length, and flight time. The visualization **1500** further includes motion characteristics such as speed, acceleration, impulse, as well as, delineation of different loads on the left foot **1512a** and the right foot **1512b**.

(116) FIGS. **16A-16B** show non-limiting examples of a first interactive visualization **1600a** and a second interactive visualization **1600b**, respectively, on a second embodiment of the software application interface. The first interactive visualization **1600a** shows live or recorded information on load applied on the left foot **1512a** and the right foot **1512b** of the user **1510**, determined from all sensors of the insole layer **120** during an individual exercise session on a certain day. The visualization **1600a** includes a heat map showing percent loading symmetry between the left foot

and the right foot for the user, and a graphical plot of peak force and average force on the left foot **1512a** and the right foot **1512b** of the user **1510**. The visualization **1600a** can be interacted to alter the presentation of the motion data such, but not limited to, viewing motion data for only the left foot **1512a** or only the right foot **1512b**, viewing motion data from only a selection of the sensors, etc.

(117) The second interactive visualization **1600b** shows live or recorded information on load applied on the left foot and the right foot of each of seven users, determined from all sensors of the insole layer **120** by each of the users during a group exercise session on a certain day. The visualization **1600b** presents individual heat maps showing percent loading symmetry between the left foot and the right foot for each of the seven users, and a graphical plot of peak force and average force on the left foot and the right foot of the each of the seven users. The visualization **1600b** can be interacted to alter the presentation of the motion data such, but not limited to, viewing motion data for only the left foot **1512a** or only the right foot **1512b**, viewing motion data from only a selection of the users, sessions, or sensors, etc.

(118) FIG. **17** shows a three-dimensional skeletal output graph **1700** representing motion of a user on a third embodiment of the software application interface. The three-dimensional skeletal output graph **1700** plots load distribution over time of individual sensing areas on the feet of the user over time during a session using one or more of the sensors described above.

(119) FIGS. **18A-18B** show non-limiting examples of a first visualization **1800a** and a second visualization **1800b**, respectively, on a fourth embodiment of the software application interface. The motion data in the visualizations **1800a** and **1800b** may be collected from the insole layer **120**. The visualization **1800a** shows a comparative graphical plot of translational displacement in three directions over time obtained from a three-axis accelerometer of the insole layer **120**, rotational displacement in three directions over time obtained from a three-axis gyroscope of the insole layer **120**, as well as magnitude of net translational and rotational displacements of the foot of the user over time. The visualization **1800b** shows a comparative graphical plot of load distribution over time measured by individual force-sensitive resistors in each region of the left foot and right foot of a user during a walking session.

(120) FIG. **19** shows a non-limiting example of an interactive visualization **1900** related to motion of a user on a fifth embodiment of the software application interface. The data in the visualization **1900** may be collected from the insole layer **120**. The interactive visualization **1900** presents a number of selectable analytical insights. The insights may include such as traditional metrics, load distribution on a foot over sessions over a period of time (e.g., six months), load dispersal, timeline of sessions from which data was collected, metrics of gait features like peak force, and longitudinal load experienced by the user. Any one of the analytical insights can be selected and then viewed for individual sessions, teams, user, and the like. One or more of these analytical insights may be derived from the motion data of the user using one or more machine learning algorithms explained above.

(121) FIG. **20** shows a block diagram of a data analytics method **2000** performed by the motion analytics system **100** using motion data generated from the sensors in the sock **110** and/or the insole layer **120** of the user. The sensors may include force-sensitive resistors that measure loading at different pressure points on the foot, three-axis accelerometers that measure translational motion of the foot, gyroscopes that measure rotational motion of the foot, magnetometers that measure change of direction during movement of the foot, temperature sensors for measuring heat-generated due to movement of the foot, electromyography sensors that measure muscle activation and fatigue, and heart sensors that measure and monitor heart health parameters of the user.

(122) The method **2000** begins in block **2010**, where at least a portion of the motion data of the user generated by the sensors, is received. The motion data may be received by a processor within the sock, the insole layer, an external computing device, a user computing device, and any device that is capable of further processing and analyzing the motion data.

(123) In block **2020**, the received data is organized. In some embodiments, the process of organizing the received data may include assigning user characteristics to the received motion data. The user characteristics may include information about the user such as, but not limited to, age, gender, location, nationality, shoe size, height, weight, surface of interaction of the user's feet, nutritional facts about the user, past injuries, physiological parameters such as heart rate and blood pressure, etc. This data may be collected by a user via an interface presented to the user on a user computing device.

(124) In some embodiments, the process of organizing the received data may include segmenting one or more portions of the received data based on one or more user-defined time-stamped sessions. As an example, the received data can be divided into data acquired during a training session, clinic session, activity session, etc., where each session has a designated time period.

(125) In some embodiments, the process of organizing the received data may further include validating the received motion data through removal of erroneous and missing data, thereby ensuring data integrity. The erroneous and missing data could be due to a dysfunctional sensor, improper capture of data, inaccurate transmission of captured data. Accordingly, it is important to purge erroneous and missing data points from received data to ensure data integrity. The erroneous and missing data may then be interpolated into the validated data to form a consistent and organized data set for further processing and analysis.

(126) In block **2030**, at least a portion of the organized data is filtered through a frequency-based signal processing filter to remove background noise and interference therefrom. In some embodiments, the frequency-based signal processing filter may be a Butterworth filter.

(127) In block **2040**, analytical data associated with one or more foot factors is determined based on the filtered data. In some embodiments, the foot factors may be a step of the user, a speed of the user, force and impulse of each step of the user, customized features based on the user characteristics, and the like. The analytical data may be determined in a number of ways. In a non-limiting embodiment, the analytical data may be determined by recognizing patterns in the filtered data through a classification algorithm, or a regression algorithm. Additionally or alternatively, the analytical data may be determined by detecting gait features of the user such as, but not limited to, ground contact time of a foot of the user, flight time of the user, a contact time of the foot of the user, a step frequency of the user, a stride length of the user, stride rate of the user, progression line of the user, a foot angle of the user, a gait center of the user, a stepping force of the user, etc.

(128) In block **2050**, the determined analytical data is categorized to provide context and insight to the user. In some embodiments, the categorization may be based on a type of motion of the user depending on a speed and acceleration of the user, force and impulse of each step of the user, a directional change of the user, etc. Additionally or alternatively, the determined analytical data is categorized based on a left foot or right foot of the user and the observant symmetry of load distribution and performance between the two. Additionally or alternatively, the determined analytical data is categorized based on dispersion of the data across regions, i.e. front portion, middle portion, and rear portion within a left foot of the user, or a right foot of the user.

(129) In some embodiments, the categorized data is further compiled and presented along with a predictive feedback on the motion of the feet of the user. The predictive feedback is determined by a supervised or an unsupervised machine learning algorithm trained on motion data and resulting outputs. In some embodiments, the predictive feedback may include information related to symmetrical distribution of forces on the feet of the user during motion, likelihood of injury of the user, one or more patterns of injury of the user, a recommended course of action to prevent an injury to the user, and the like. In some embodiments, the predictive feedback may be presented along with interactive visualizations to provide context and insight about the motion data to the user. The motion data, the interactive visualizations, and the predictive feedback may be downloaded or exported in various formats by the user for future use, study, and research.

(130) FIG. **21** shows a block diagram of a non-limiting example of a machine-learning (ML)

architecture **2100** used by the data analytics method **2000**. In practice, the motion data and the related data analytics are used to detect patterns and determine a probability of injury, based on workload on the feet, number of sessions, etc. The ML architecture **2100** is a merely an example. The ML architecture **2100** includes a central ML pipeline **2102**, a data preprocessor **2104**, a data processor **2106**, and a classifier **2108**. Motion data is fed into the ML architecture **2100** to generate features and analytics of the data.

(131) In some embodiments, initially, unsupervised ML techniques may be used to detect data groups between individuals, without any additional inputs other than raw motion data from the insole layer **120**. Due to the nature of unsupervised learning, there is no information regarding the ML decision-making process. The unsupervised groupings will separate athletes with similar movement characteristics that is used to deepen insight from concurrently collected injury data. The user or the user's practitioner can collaborate with the team to standardize the recording process for athletes presenting with musculoskeletal (MSK) complaints or injury, throughout the season. MSK complaint and injury data may then be used as inputs for a supervised ML model aimed at detecting the probability of an athlete having MSK complaint or injury in subsequent training sessions.

(132) The motion data generated may also be synchronized with data generated by another wearable device using time stamps to train a decision-tree classifier or a neural network model that predicts the user's performance and likelihood of injury. The decision-tree classifier is a supervised machine-learning technique that involves asking a series of questions based on different variables to reach a conclusion. The variables include a user's previous health issues, the total distance they have covered in a session and the distance covered at high speed, for an athletic session as an example. Other variations that can be used for decision-tree-based methods, are 'random forest' or 'gradient boosting' techniques, which use multiple decision trees to incrementally improve forecasts. Another machine-learning technology, known as deep neural networks, could yield even greater accuracy.

(133) Advantageously, the systems and methods of monitoring human foot performance enables continuously measuring and understanding dynamic stress load, particularly cumulative lower limb loading and balance. Further, the systems and methods differentiate between changes in external loading experienced by the user, as well as limb-to-limb symmetry in loading. This aids in generating contexts and insights for a user, particularly in metrics related to load, force distribution, and gait. This helps the users, medical practitioners, and coaches gain a deeper understanding of the physical demands during training, open play, rehabilitation sessions, as well as prevent and predict injuries.

(134) Although the disclosed embodiments have been illustrated and described with respect to one or more implementations, equivalent alterations and modifications will occur or be known to others skilled in the art upon the reading and understanding of this specification and the annexed drawings. In addition, while a particular feature of the invention may have been disclosed with respect to only one of several implementations, such feature may be combined with one or more other features of the other implementations as may be desired and advantageous for any given or particular application.

(135) While various embodiments of the present disclosure have been described above, it should be understood that they have been presented by way of example only, and not limitation. Numerous changes to the disclosed embodiments can be made in accordance with the disclosure herein, without departing from the spirit or scope of the disclosure. Thus, the breadth and scope of the present disclosure should not be limited by any of the above described embodiments. Rather, the scope of the disclosure should be defined in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. An insole layer comprising: a top cover layer; a bottom cover layer; and a flexible printed circuit board disposed between the top cover layer and the bottom cover layer, wherein the flexible printed circuit board has a single layer with a top surface in direct contact with the top cover layer and the single layer has a bottom surface in direct contact with the bottom cover layer, and wherein the flexible printed circuit board includes a rear portion having concave edges and a plurality of kerf bend cuts for (i) forming a concave pattern around the concave edges of the rear portion of the flexible printed circuit board, wherein the plurality of kerf bend cuts forming the concave pattern are parallel to the concave edges of the rear portion, (ii) separating a central enclosure from the rear portion, and (iii) enabling longitudinal bending of a front portion of the flexible printed circuit board, and wherein the flexible printed circuit board comprising: a motion-tracking device having a plurality of sensors, wherein each sensor is configured to detect motion of one of a plurality of sensing areas disposed adjacent to a lower surface of the flexible printed circuit board; a processor configured to receive motion data generated by the motion-tracking device; and a power supply device coupled to the motion-tracking device and the processor.
2. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the insole layer is shaped to be placed inside a shoe, a sock, or under an existing insole of a shoe and is removable to be placed inside another shoe, sock or existing insole.
3. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the insole layer has a shape customized to correspond to a foot of a user.
4. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the top cover layer and the bottom cover layer are formed from a water-resistant polyester material.
5. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein each of the top cover layer and the bottom cover layer includes a slippery upper surface and a slip-resistant lower surface.
6. The insole layer of claim 5, wherein the slip-resistant lower surface is formed by a rubber layer disposed under each of the top cover layer and the bottom cover layer.
7. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the flexible printed circuit board is formed from a glass-reinforced epoxy laminate material.
8. The insole layer of claim 1, further comprising a layer of ethylene propylene diene monomer (EPDM) foam disposed between the flexible printed circuit board and the bottom cover layer.
9. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the plurality of sensors include: (i) one or more force-sensitive resistors, (ii) one or more three-axis accelerometers, (iii) one or more three-axis gyroscopes, (iv) one or more magnetometers, (v) one or more temperature sensors, (vi) one or more electromyography sensors, (vii) one or more heart rate sensors, or (viii) any combination thereof.
10. The insole layer of claim 9, wherein the one or more three-axis accelerometers includes at least one high-G accelerometer.
11. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein a distribution of the plurality of sensing areas on the lower surface of the flexible printed circuit board corresponds to pressure points on the foot of the user.
12. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein flexible printed circuit board further comprises a central enclosure for housing (i) the motion-tracking device, (ii) the power supply device, (iii) the processor, or (iv) any combination thereof.
13. The insole layer of claim 12, wherein the central enclosure comprises an upper frame, a lower frame, and a covering plate coupled to the lower frame.
14. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the flexible printed circuit board further comprises (i) a front sensor module adjacent to a front portion thereof and (ii) a rear sensor module adjacent to a rear portion thereof and electronically connected to the front sensor module, wherein each of the front sensor module and the rear sensor module includes one or more of the plurality of sensing areas and one or more ventilation openings.
15. The insole layer of claim 14, wherein each of the one or more ventilation openings are covered by a waterproof membrane.

16. The insole layer of claim 14, wherein each of the plurality of sensing areas includes a load concentrator encapsulated within an adhesive film.
 17. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the power supply device is a rechargeable lithium polymer battery.
 18. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the flexible printed circuit board further comprises a charging socket configured to charge the power supply device by direct current (DC) charging.
 19. The insole layer of claim 18, wherein the charging socket is disposed adjacent to a rear portion of the flexible printed circuit board.
 20. The insole layer of claim 18, wherein the charging socket comprises an attachment bracket having: one or more cutouts for placing magnetic attachments of a DC charging station; and one or more through-holes to accommodate guide pins of the DC charging station.
 21. The insole layer of claim 20, wherein the DC charging station is (i) a stationary rack module, or (ii) a portable sleeve module.
 22. The insole layer of claim 1, further comprising a radio-frequency (RF) transmitting antenna and a RF receiving antenna for bidirectional RF communication that enables (i) data exchange with an external computing device, (ii) wireless charging of the power supply device, or (iii) both.
 23. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the flexible printed circuit board further includes a router device for enabling wireless internet communication.
 24. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the flexible printed circuit board further comprises a piezoelectric energy-harvesting device including a piezoelectric force plate configured to convert the kinetic energy generated through movement of the insole layer into electrical energy for charging the power supply device.
 25. The insole layer of claim 1, further comprising: a non-transitory processor-readable memory coupled to the processor, the non-transitory processor-readable memory comprising machine-readable instructions stored thereon that, when executed by the processor, causes the processor to: encrypt the generated data from the motion-tracking device; and upload the encrypted data to a block chain, or an external computing device over a wireless communication channel.
 26. The insole layer of claim 25, wherein the machine-readable instructions when executed by the processor, further causes the processor to: download data from an external computing device over the wireless communication channel; and decrypt the downloaded data.
 27. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the data generated by the motion-tracking device is used by (i) the processor, (ii) a user computing device, (iii) an external computing device, or (iv) any combination thereof, to present interactive visualizations on the motion of the user.
 28. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the data generated by the motion-tracking device is used by (i) the processor, (ii) a user computing device, (iii) an external computing device, or (iv) any combination thereof, to provide a predictive feedback on the motion of the feet of the user, the predictive feedback determined by a machine learning algorithm.
 29. The insole layer of claim 28, wherein the machine learning algorithm is one of: (i) a supervised algorithm, or (ii) an unsupervised algorithm.
 30. The insole layer of claim 1, wherein the plurality of sensors include a first sensor in a first area and a second sensor in a second area, wherein the first sensor includes a first load concentrator having a first thickness, and the second sensor includes a second load concentrator having a second thickness different from the first thickness.
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